

CHAPTER II

LEARNING OUTCOME 1:

PREPARE APPETIZERS

Objectives

This module deals with the skills and knowledge required in preparing and presenting appetizers. Upon completion of this module, you should be able to:

LO2. 1. Identify the origin of appetizer;

LO2. 2. Perform Mise en place;

LO2. 3. Prepare a range of appetizers;

LO2. 4. Present a range of appetizers; and

LO2. 5. Store appetizers.



History of Appetizer

Appetizers were originally introduced by the Athenians as a buffet in the early third century B.C. They would serve sea urchins, cockles, sturgeon, and garlic. However, they were unpopular to start as these tiny meals weren't followed up with a main course, leaving everyone hungry and wanting more. It wasn't until the nineteenth century that appetizers truly caught on, as meals evolved into more of a structured ordeal.



Aperitifs came about by the Romans and were classified as a liquid appetizer that typically contained alcohol. In addition to inciting hunger like food appetizers, the purposes for aperitifs were also meant to help with the imminent digestion process. These drinks would be shared from a single glass and passed around the table to all members of



the eating party. Aperitifs are still utilized today, typically with the company of food appetizers.

The word itself, "appetizer," as being used in America and England in the 1860s, is more of a local flavor than "hors d'oeuvres." For a time, appetizers are

served between the main course and dessert as a refresher, but by the twentieth century they had taken their place as a precursor to the main course.

On the other hand it is said that appetizers are the dishes that can truly be considered Filipino because we are best known for using our hands to eat the small finger foods that come with the first course. Appetizers can include anything from fish to meat, nuts and chips. They are often served before dinner or at large family lunches.





LEARNING OUTCOME 2:
PERFORM MISE EN
PLACE

Objectives

After learning the content of this lesson, you will be able to:

- 2.2.1. Identify tools and equipment needed in the preparation of appetizers;
- 2.2.2 Clean, sanitize and prepare tools and equipment based on the required tasks;
- 2.2.3 Classify appetizers according to ingredients; and
- 2.2.4 Identify ingredients according to the given recipe.

Mise' En Place is a French term which means “*set in place*” that is you have everything ready to cook and in its place. You should be able to identify and prepare all the needed tools and equipment as well as all the ingredients to make the preparation and cooking easily



The following are the tools and equipment needed in preparing appetizer

Kitchen Tools and Equipment



Ball Cutter - sharp edged scoop for cutting out balls of fruits and vegetables



Rubber Spatula - used to scrape off contents of bowls



Channel knife - small hand tool in making garnishes



Spatula - used for manipulating foods like spreading



Paring knife –
Used for trimmings
and pairing fruits
and vegetables



Cutting board -
board for cutting
fruits and
vegetables



Kitchen shear



Potato masher –
designed to press
potato and cooked
vegetables



Oven - used
for baking



Chiller - used for
keeping cold foods
chilled for service

Other Tools and Equipment used in Preparing Appetizers

1. Measuring spoons are used for measuring dry and liquid ingredients I small quantity.
2. Measuring cups are used to measure dry ingredients. They come in various sizes and volumes.
3. Glass measuring cup is usually transparent. It is smooth in the inside with the graduation mark on the outside to read. This is used for measuring liquid ingredients like water and oil.
4. Mixing bowls containers with smooth, rounded interior surfaces with no creases to retain some mixture.

5. Mixing spoon is used for mixing ingredients. It is made of wood in different sizes and different length of the handle.

6. Paring knife is used to remove the skin covering of fruit and vegetables.

7. Fork is used to combine ingredients.

8. Container of different sizes and shapes.

9. Cooking range/stove

10. Refrigerator

11. Strainer/colander

Appetizers are foods which stimulate the appetite, through their attractive appearance, fragrance or appealing flavor. It is a small piece or a portion of highly seasoned food, usually served before a meal to induce and stimulate one's appetite. It gives appreciation to the food we eat. A good appetizer, whether hot or cold should be light and served in small quantities, Fresh vegetable and salads, fruits, or meat or even fish can be made into appetizers.

Classification of Appetizers

1. **Cocktail** - These are usually juices of orange, pineapple, grapefruit or tomatoes served with cold salad dressings. It may be in the form of a fruit or vegetable juice mixed with little alcoholic beverage or seafood like shrimps, crabs, or lobsters served with slightly seasoned sauce.



2. **Hors D' Oeuvres** - These are small portions of highly seasoned foods. It is a combination of canapés, olives, stuffed celery, pickled radishes, and fish. It is served on individual plate when guests are seated. Sometimes this is simply placed on a platter and passed around. Hors d'oeuvres are served cold or hot.



3. **Cana** - These are made out of thin slices of bread in different shapes. The bread may be toasted, sautéed in butter or dipped in a well-seasoned mixture of egg, cheese, fish, or meat then deep-fat fried. It is a finger food consisting of three parts: a base, a spread or topping and garnish. They could be served hot or cold. There are no set recipes for the making of canapés. You may create your own combination of several different colored items on the cut pieces of bread, toasted or fried and biscuits etc.



4. **Relishes/Crudités** - These are pickled item which are raw, crisp vegetables such as julienne carrots or celery sticks. Relishes are generally placed before the guest in a slightly, deep, boat shape dish.



5. **Petite Salads** - These are small portions of salads and usually display the characteristics found in most salads.



6. **Chips and Dips** - These are popular accompaniments to potato chips, crackers, and raw vegetables. Proper consistency in the preparation is important for many dips. It must not be so thick that it cannot be scooped up without breaking the chip or crackers, but it must be thick enough to stick to the items used as dippers.



7. Fresh Fruits and Vegetables - These are the simplest appetizers. Fruits are good appetizers because they give an attractive appearance, fragrance, appealing taste and delicious flavor. For example, you could serve a platter of thinly sliced cucumbers, chunks of red bell pepper and baby carrots. For a fruit tray, consider serving red and green grapes, as well as chunks of mango with toothpicks inserted in them. Since appetizers are always easy to pick up with the fingers, they should never be drippy or messy.



8. **Finger foods** - These are variety of appetizers wherein the only requirement is that you keep everything small enough to be picked up with the fingers and eaten with little mess. If you want to serve your favorite homemade sausages, cut them into small pieces, wrap them with a small piece of pastry shell and bake. Or, serve your favorite baked sweet potato fries with a mayonnaise-based dipping sauce. Individual quiches filled with ham and cheese is another good option.



The following are examples of appetizers including the materials/ingredients on how to prepare Canapés

Canapés – bite-size open faced sandwiches consist of tiny portions of food presented on bases of bread, toast, or pastry easily handled and eaten.

Canapé Consists of Three Parts

1. Base – holds the spread and garnish. Crackers and toasts are firmer and give a pleasing texture and crispness to the canapé.



Bread cutouts



Toast Cutouts



Crackers



Tiny unsweetened pastry shells



Tortilla Chips



Biscuits



Mini Pancakes



Tiny Biscuits

2. Spread - placed on top of the base so the garnish sticks to it without falling off.



Butter



Meat or Fish



Garnish



Garnish salad spread

Food Items Used to Decorate Canapés

A. Vegetables, pickles and relishes

Radish Slices

Pickled Onions

Chutney

Parley

Tomatoes

Olives

Pickles

Asparagus Tips

Cucumber Slices

Pimiento



B. Fish

Smoked Fish

Smoked Salmon

Shrimp

Caviar

Shrimp

Tuna Flakes

Sardines Lobster / Chunks or slices



C. Meats

Turkey

Ham

Salami

Roast beef

Chicken



D. Cheese, hard cooked egg slices



Guidelines for Assembling Canapés

Good mise en place is essential. In making canapés especially for large functions, all bases, spreads and garnishes must be prepared ahead of time so that final assembly may go quickly and smoothly.

Assemble as close as possible to serving time. Bases quickly become soggy, and spreads and garnishes dry out easily. After placing them in a tray, cover them lightly with plastic and hold for a short time under refrigeration. Safe food handling and storage must be observed. Select harmonious flavor combinations in spreads and garnish such as:

- A. Mustard and ham
- B. Lemon butter and caviar
- C. Pimiento cream cheese and sardines

D. Tuna salad and capers

E. Anchovy butter, hard cooked egg slice and olive

Make sure that at least one of the ingredients is spicy in flavor. A bland canapé has little value as an appetizer. Use high quality ingredients. Leftovers can be used for canapés, but they must be carefully handled and stored to retain freshness. Keep it simple. Simple meat arrangements are more attractive than extravagant one. Be sure that canapés hold together and do not fall apart in the customers hands.

Arrange canapés carefully and attractively on trays. Each tray should carry an assortment of flavor and textures, so there is something for every taste.

Kinds of Cocktail Appetizers



Oysters and Clams on half shells



Shrimp



Crab



Lobster



Fruits



Firm Flake

1. Relishes are raw or pickled vegetables cut into attractive shapes served as appetizer, include two categories:

Raw vegetables with dips - These are known as crudités (croo dee tays). Cru in French means — “raw”. Common bite size, cut raw vegetables served with dips are:

- ♣ Radish
- ♣ Green and Red Pepper
- ♣ Zucchini
- ♣ Cucumber
- ♣ Cauliflower
- ♣ Broccoli Florets
- ♣ Celery



2. **Dips** – accompaniment to raw vegetables, and sometime potato chips and crackers. Any mixture of spreads can be used as dips. Proper consistency is important to any dip. It must not be so thick that it cannot be scooped up without breaking the cracker. It must be thick enough to stick to the items used as dippers. Thin or soften them by adding mayonnaise, cream or other appropriate liquid. Sauces and salad dressings can be used as dips.



3. **Pickled items.** Includes variety of items like cucumber pickles, olives, watermelon pickles, pickled peppers, spiced beets, and other preserved fruits and vegetables





LEARNING OUTCOME 3:

**PREPARE A RANGE OF
APPETIZERS**



Objectives

At the end of this lesson, you are expected to:

2.3.1 Differentiate hot and cold appetizers;

2.3.2 Prepare a variety of appetizers; and 2.3.3 Follow workplace safety procedures.

Preparation of appetizers require knowledge and skills in preparing of the different recipes. This lesson provides you different recipes in preparing appetizers for your guidance and reference.

Hot and Cold Appetizers

Hors d'oeuvres are often served preceding a meal; they are served as the food at cocktail parties involving alcoholic beverages

a. Hot Hors d'oeuvres are served between the soup and fish course. In today's shortened menus, they are often served instead of hot entrée. The size and richness depend upon the composition of menu. Many hot hors d'oeuvres are suited for serving a small ala carte dishes, and usually described as hot dish.

b. Cold hors d'oeuvres should stimulate appetite, and therefore should always be served at the first course in the menu. There are five types of cold hors d'oeuvres and they are served as follows:

- *Plate of Hors d'oeuvres* may consist of shrimps, smoked beef, poached egg, Spanish sardines and lettuce, sauce can be served at the side.



- *Grison Platter* may consist of two kinds of cold meat, such as ham, smoked beef, peppered ham. Sauce can be served at the side.

- *Hors d'oeuvres Platter*. A well-presented platter with a limited choice of simple or more expensive foods. The basic rule is “small quantity, but big in quality” and at the same time attractively served. It may consist of shrimps with jelly, asparagus tip with mushrooms, sardines with onion rings, tomatoes stuffed with salad and chicken loaf.



- *Assorted hors d'oeuvres* can be served in special portioned platters with dishes or even from a serving cart.



- *Rich hors d'oeuvres* - still a classical form of presentation. Lobster should always be included. The hors d'oeuvres dish system in conjunction with a silver platter can be used, but it is also possible to arrange the center pieces on a silver platter covered with meat jelly and served with accompaniments in a small separate bowls or container.





LEARNING OUTCOME 4:
PRESENT A RANGE OF
APPETIZERS

Objectives

At the end of this lesson, you are expected to:

- 2.4.1. Identify the fundamentals of plating;
- 2.4.2 Identify the accompaniments of appetizers;
- 2.4.3. Present appetizers attractively; and
- 2.4.4. Observe sanitary practices in presenting appetizers

Appetizers can be more appreciated if presented attractively like the saying goes “the eyes eats first”. Plate presentation is the process of offering the appetizer to guests in a stylish and pleasing manner. It requires skills, style and creativity.



Fundamentals of Plating

1. Balance

The rules of good menu balance also apply to plating. Select foods and garnishes that offer variety and contrast.

- **Color.** Two or more colors on a plate are usually more interesting than one. Garnish is also important.
- **Shapes.** Plan for variety of shapes and forms. Cutting vegetables into different shapes gives you great flexibility.
- **Texture.** Not strictly visual consideration, but important in plating in menu planning.
- **Flavors.** One of the factors to consider when balancing colors, shapes, and texture on the plate.

2. Portion size.

This is important for presentation as well as for costing.

- Match portion sizes and plates. Too small a plate makes an overcrowded, jumbled, messy appearance. Too large a plate makes the portions look skimpy.
- Balance the portion sizes of the various items on the plate. Apply logical balance of portions.

3. Arrangement on the plate

3.1 The three elements of a buffet platter.

- Centerpiece or Grosse piece (gross pyess). This may be an uncut portion of the main food item, such as a pate or a cold roast, decorated and displayed whole. It may be a separate but related item, such as molded salmon mousse
- The slices or serving portions should be arranged artistically.
- The garnish should be artistically done in proportion to the cut slices.

3.2. The food should be easy to handle and serve, so that one premove without ruining the arrangement.

3.3. A simple design is best. Simple arrangement is easier to serve, more appetizing, and still attractive when are half consumed by the guest.

3.4. Attractive platter presentation may be made on silver or other metals, on mirrors, chinaware, plastic ware, wood, or any other materials provided they are presentable and suitable for food.

3.5. Once a piece of food has touched the tray, do not remove it. Shiny silver or mirror trays are easily smudged, and you'll have to wash the tray and start over again. Good pre-planning should be considered.

3.6. Think of the platter as part of the whole. It must be attractive and appropriate to the other presentation in the table

Designing the platter

- 1. Plan ahead.** Make a sketch by dividing the tray into six or eight sections. This will help you lay out a balance and symmetrical design. The sketch should indicate the centerpiece, slices of foods and garnishes.
- 2. Get movement into your design.** Good design makes your eyes move across the platter following the lines you have set up. It could be arranged in rows or lines.
- 3. Give the design a focal point.** Use centerpiece to emphasize and strengthen the design by giving it direction and height. Note that centerpiece is not always in the center.
- 4. Keep items in proportion.**

5. Make the garnish count. Use garnish to balance out a plate by providing additional element. Two items on a plate often look unbalanced, but adding a garnish completes the picture. On the other hand do not add unnecessary garnishes.

6. Don't drown every plate in sauce or gravy. It may hides colors and shapes. You may cover a part of it or a band of sauce across the center.

7. Keep it simple. Simplicity is more attractive than complicated designs.

8. Let the guest see the best side of everything. Angle overlapping slices and wedged-shaped pieces toward the customer and the best side of each slice is face up.